

MERMAID • BOTH FENCE CHARACTERS

A tilde fence draws its diagram

CommonMark fences with backticks **or** tildes, and Markdown treats the two as the same thing. The live preview always did. The export did not — until this deck.

What was wrong, and where

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS

The CLI substituted an SVG for a backtick fence and nothing else, so a tilde fence printed as **raw source** in the PDF.

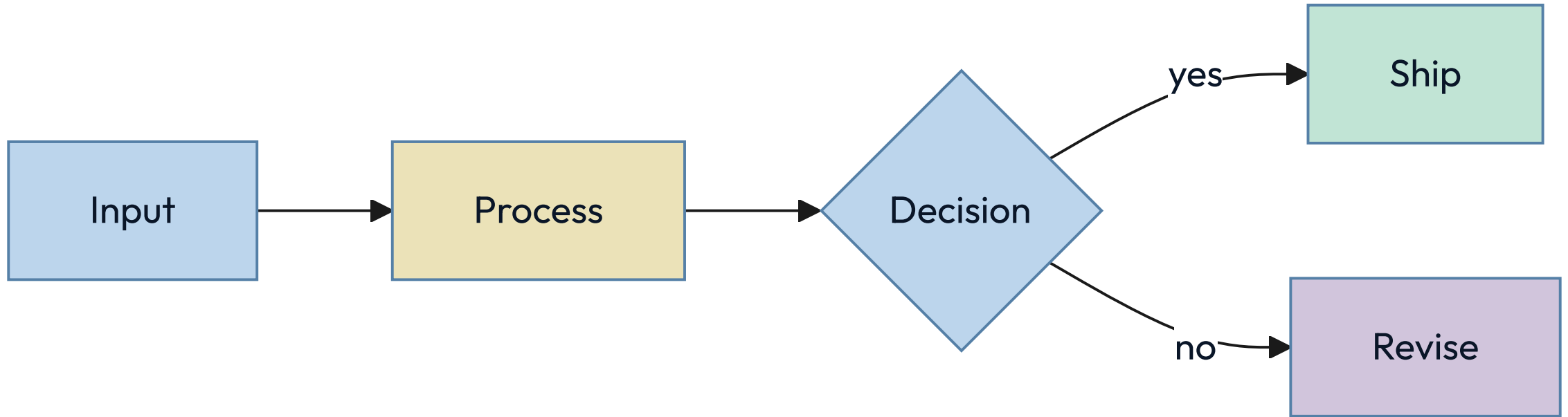
The author could not see it coming: the preview they wrote in renders both. The next two slides are one diagram, written two ways.

KEY INSIGHT

markdown-it emits `class="language-mermaid"` for either fence, and the runtime keys on that class.

A backtick fence.

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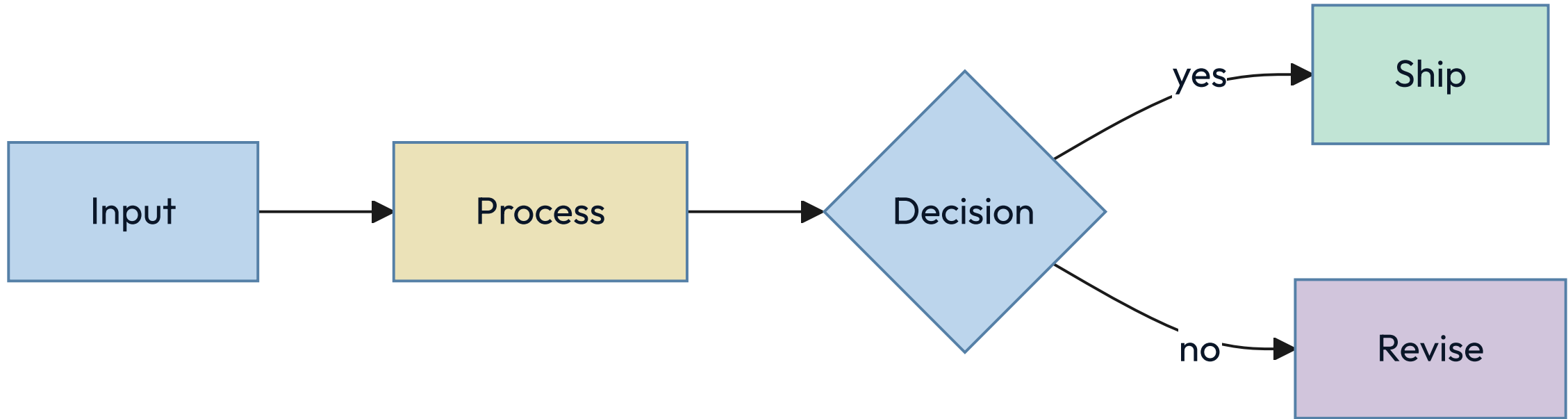


KEY INSIGHT

The form every deck in this repo already uses.

A tilde fence.

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KEY INSIGHT

Identical bytes on the slide. Before this change, this page printed five lines of Mermaid source.

One matcher, two paths

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The pattern lives in `lib/core/mermaid-fences.js`, and both callers read it: the CLI's substitution, and the **narrator** that speaks a diagram slide. Widening one alone would have drawn a diagram the voice could not read.

It is no looser than the regex it replaced, so a backtick fence substitutes to the same bytes it always did.